How the Department of the Army Office of the Inspector General Helped the Department of Defense and Central Intelligence Agency Lie to the American People

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March 2026

HHC, A&B Platoon, 307th Engineer Battalion, 82nd Airborne Division, Present at Khamisiyah, March 1991

I. Background and Argument

On March 4, 1991, soldiers from the 37th Engineer Battalion demolished thirty-seven ammunition bunkers at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point in southern Iraq. Bunker 73 contained sarin and cyclosarin rockets. That demolition was never modeled for atmospheric dispersion. The entire official exposure assessment for Khamisiyah was based on the March 10 pit demolition, a separate and substantially smaller event. Veterans present only on March 4 who had completed retrograde operations before March 10 were subsequently reclassified as unexposed, removed from the exposure list, and carried unexposed status in data that may have introduced misclassification bias into Gulf War illness epidemiological research.

This paper documents how that outcome was produced. The argument is specific: a northeast wind direction for the March 4 Bunker 73 demolition was required to exclude that event from the exposure assessment. That conclusion could not be stated publicly until the witness record existed to support it. The witness record was constructed under Army Inspector General control through 1996 and 1997. The construction required the

positioning, management, and sequential interview of the key commanders at Fort Leavenworth, at Fort Leonard Wood, and through a network of installation-based proceedings controlled by the IG at every node. When the witness foundation was complete, the northeast transport direction was publicly asserted for the first time at the July 24, 1997 Pentagon press briefing. The Department of the Army Inspector General report, published October 10, 1997, ratified the established narrative. The December 1999 Rostker-Walpole correspondence closed the question permanently.

The paper reconstructs this sequence from the government's own archived documents: Lead Reports from the OSAGWI investigation database, the DAIG Report, the OSAGWI Khamisiyah case narratives, the CBS Evening News broadcast of February 12, 1997, the DoD/CIA press briefing transcript of July 24, 1997, the Rostker-Walpole correspondence, Army biographical records, contemporaneous GulfLINK news articles, and the Essayons newspaper. The conclusions are derived from that record.

II. The Author and the Evidentiary Foundation

The author was assigned to Headquarters and Headquarters Company, A&B Platoon, 307th Engineer Battalion, 82nd Airborne Division, attached to A Company. He was present at Khamisiyah from March 4 through March 18, 1991, within two miles of the Bunker 73 detonation, and was present at Tallil Air Base on March 3, 1991, when the command decision to proceed with demolition was communicated. He drove one of the two five-ton dump trucks that hauled all demolition supplies to the bunkers, warehouses, and pit. No M8 chemical agent detection tape was applied to that vehicle. None was applied to any vehicle, any uniform, or any equipment during the nine-day operation.

Serving subsequently as Executive Director of the National Gulf War Resource Center from October 1996 through July 1997, the author testified before the Presidential Advisory Committee on Gulf War Veterans' Illnesses on October 9, 1996, testified before the House Committee on Veterans' Affairs on February 11, April 9, and June 19, 1997, served as advisor to the Presidential Advisory Committee Special Report of January 1997, and drafted S.2358,

the Persian Gulf War Veterans Act of 1998. He was invited by OSAGWI to observe the Dugway Proving Ground replication tests and was present in the control room during the validation testing, making him the only individual known to have both conducted the Khamisiyah demolitions and witnessed the tests designed to model them. During the OSAGWI investigative tour he insisted on filing a lead report documenting his firsthand account of the March 4 events. That report does not appear in any publicly available record. He was present at the Leavenworth 5+1 press conference in May 1997, sitting in the broadcast truck of a Kansas City news outlet after the IG officer running the event denied him entry.

III. What an IG Investigation Is and What This One Was Not

The Inspector General Act of 1978 establishes that Inspectors General exist to conduct independent and objective audits and investigations. Army Regulation 20-1 states that IG investigations will be conducted without command influence, that findings will reflect the facts as determined by independent inquiry, and that the IG will not be directed as to what conclusions to reach.

The DAIG Report's own Phase 3 methodology section states plainly that the investigation was coordinated with the CIA modeling effort it was ostensibly evaluating. It describes coordination with the Gulf War Declassification Project, the Investigative and Analysis Division of OSAGWI, the Persian Gulf War Focus Group at the Defense Intelligence Agency, the DoD Inspector General Agency, and the Central Intelligence Agency. It notes the coordinated effort of all involved and interested agencies in the DoD and CIA effort to model the plume from the possible March 10 release. The investigation, the modeling, and the congressional presentation were conducted by the same institutional apparatus during the same operational period. The DAIG was not independent of the CIA modeling effort. It was coordinated with and contributed to the same analytical process that produced the conclusions its findings were ostensibly evaluating.

An investigation conducted in coordination with the agencies whose conclusions it is evaluating, whose witnesses are managed through the investigative apparatus of the body being investigated, and whose findings arrive after the CIA has already published the technical framework within which they will be interpreted, does not meet the statutory or regulatory standard. It is an administrative ratification process. What follows is a documentary account of how that process operated.

IV. Who Ran the Investigation and Why It Mattered

The Khamisiyah investigation was not a single agency undertaking. It was a network of officials connected through prior institutional relationships, simultaneous appointments, and overlapping responsibilities, each positioned at a node where they could orient the investigation's output toward a predetermined outcome.

John Deutch created the Persian Gulf Illnesses Investigation Team in March 1995 while serving as Deputy Secretary of Defense. He became Director of Central Intelligence (DCI) in May 1995, taking the PGIIT's institutional framework with him into the CIA. By September 1995, a CIA reassessment under his directorship identified Khamisiyah as a possible chemical agent release site and the PGIIT began working the Khamisiyah lead. The earliest Khamisiyah witness interviews, beginning in June 1996, were PGIIT work product, created under the institutional authority of the body Deutch founded, while Deutch was Director of Central Intelligence. Under his directorship the CIA completed the modeling of Bunker 73, producing the analytical basis that became the sole justification for excluding March 4 from the official exposure assessment. Deutch departed the CIA in December 1996 following congressional testimony in which he told Congress that Saddam Hussein was stronger than before and that the CIA might never remedy the problem. In January 1997, the CIA began a formal security investigation after Deutch's personal laptops were found to contain classified information wrongfully labeled unclassified. Senior CIA officials actively hampered the investigation. The matter was referred to the Department of Justice more than two years after his departure. Attorney General Reno declined prosecution. Following the 2000 CIA Inspector General investigation report, George Tenet,

the deputy Deutch had elevated, revoked Deutch's security clearances. On January 19, 2001, Deutch agreed to plead guilty to a misdemeanor for mishandling government secrets. President Clinton pardoned him on his last day in office, two days before the Department of Justice could file the case. In January 1998, Deutch co-founded Intellibridge Corporation alongside Anthony Lake, Clinton's former National Security Advisor, as a corporate intelligence service whose clients included the U.S. military. He subsequently joined the board of directors of Science Applications International Corporation, the principal defense contractor in the Khamisiyah modeling infrastructure; his authorized biography confirms the board membership, and SEC proxy filings establish that the appointment postdated the 2002 OSAGWI Final Report and the December 1999 Rostker-Walpole correspondence. SAIC conducted the single model run that produced the northeast wind conclusion while Deutch was DCI. The official who created the investigative body, directed the CIA that produced the northeast wind conclusion, faced criminal prosecution for mishandling classified material, received a presidential pardon two days before the case could be filed, and joined the board of the contractor whose infrastructure conducted the tests that validated the modeling his CIA had produced, is the same official.

Deputy Secretary of Defense John White chaired the Senior Level Oversight Panel that directed the Gulf War illness investigation from 1994 through his departure in July 1997. On October 2, 1996, White ordered creation of the Rostker action team to reassess the ongoing investigation, drawing explicitly on resources outside the purview of Dr. Stephen Joseph, the Assistant Secretary of Defense for Health Affairs who had previously managed the investigation. The action team reported directly to White rather than through Joseph's office. Joseph remained in his position and continued testifying before Congress through February 1997, but operational control of the investigation had been stripped from his office by administrative reorganization. White co-convened the IDA panel review of the CIA's Pit modeling alongside former Director of Central Intelligence Deutch in 1997. White departed the Pentagon on July 15, 1997, returning to RAND Corporation as a Senior Fellow.

Paul Wallner served as White's Staff Director for the Senior Level Oversight Panel. On November 3, 1995, Wallner authored an internal memorandum ordering the flagging of "potential sensitive reports or documents on GulfLINK" and directing preparation of

responses to particular "bombshell" reports. Three months later, on February 8, 1996, DoD removed 308 previously published files from the GulfLINK website, citing the need for classification review despite their earlier electronic publication. Under pressure from veterans groups and front-page coverage in the New York Times, 88 files were returned in August 1996. The remainder were not restored. Wallner delivered a public briefing to the Presidential Advisory Committee documenting the scope of the declassification program while simultaneously managing the apparatus that had just removed 308 documents from that program. After White's departure in July 1997, Wallner's name does not appear in any subsequent public record.

Bernard Rostker came to government from RAND Corporation. Appointed by White in October 1996, he directed OSAGWI, coordinated the modeling parameters with the CIA, and commissioned RAND to review the medical and scientific literature on Gulf War illness causation. White returned to RAND as a Senior Fellow in July 1997 while Rostker remained at OSAGWI as the commissioning authority. Every RAND report on the GulfLINK RAND Reports page, spanning November 1998 through January 2001, was produced while White held his RAND Senior Fellowship and Rostker was commissioning the work. After departing government, Rostker returned to RAND and published RAND Paper P-8066 in 2002, citing the RAND literature reviews he had commissioned while heading OSAGWI as independent validation of the conclusions he had reached while commissioning them. The word "independent" carried the entire weight of the validation claim. Every link in the chain ran through the same two men at the same institution.

George Tenet served as Deutch's deputy and became acting DCI at the precise moment the CIA's formal security investigation of Deutch's classified laptop material was being initiated. Reopening the Khamisiyah northeast wind conclusion, the analytical product of Deutch's CIA, would have surfaced the work of the director whose security breach Tenet was responsible for containing. Tenet appointed Robert Walpole to head the CIA's Gulf War Illnesses Task Force. Walpole publicly acknowledged at the July 24, 1997 press briefing that the Bunker 73 modeling had been completed, then coordinated with Rostker through the December 1999 correspondence that permanently closed the question without releasing the results.

The physical geography of the investigation reflected the institutional clustering of its actors. The S3/G3 conferences that validated unit location data were held at Fort Belvoir, Virginia, as documented in a contemporaneous GulfLINK news article. Fort Belvoir simultaneously housed the Army Inspector General School, where every DAIG investigator had been certified; the Defense Mapping School, where the B Company Commander of the 37th Engineer Battalion was stationed at the time of his June 1996 interview; the U.S. Army Intelligence and Security Command; and the Humphreys Engineer Center, institutional home of the engineer branch whose officers provided the primary witness testimony. The battalion-level commanders were at Fort Leonard Wood. Carl A. Strock had commanded the 307th Engineer Battalion through the Khamisiyah demolition operation and subsequently served as Chief of Staff at the U.S. Army Engineer Training Center at Fort Leonard Wood. Robert Flowers had commanded the 20th Engineer Brigade, the parent headquarters over both the 37th and 307th Engineer Battalions during the demolition, and assumed command of Fort Leonard Wood on July 31, 1997, the same month OSAGWI completed the first S3/G3 conference series for XVIII Airborne Corps units. The company commanders with direct operational responsibility at Khamisiyah, five officers who would later be assembled at Fort Leavenworth for the May 1997 proceedings that became known as the Leavenworth 5+1, were simultaneously promoted and assigned to Command and Staff College at Fort Leavenworth during the active Phase 3 interview campaign. The unit location validation and IG investigator certification infrastructure was at Fort Belvoir. Every level of the Khamisiyah command chain was simultaneously positioned at an installation where the investigation was being conducted, the testimony was being shaped, and the exposure data was being validated.

At every node, including the investigative body, the modeling agency, the contracting infrastructure, the document disclosure apparatus, and the post-government validation machinery, the same network of officials occupied positions simultaneously relevant to the Khamisiyah outcome and personally insulated from the consequences of that outcome for veterans.

V. How the Witness Record Was Built

The earliest Khamisiyah Lead Reports were produced in June 1996 by the PGIIT, before the DAIG directive of September 25, 1996 and before OSAGWI assumed investigative responsibility on November 12, 1996. Northeast transport of the March 4 plume could not be publicly asserted until the witness record existed to support it. The construction of that record proceeded through three phases.

The first phase was the PGIIT interview campaign of June through December 1996. The PGIIT operated with twelve staff and a $4.1 million budget before being replaced by OSAGWI with two hundred personnel and $29.4 million. The three earliest interviews in the series documented the 37th Engineer Battalion chemical NCO on June 3, the B Company Commander of the 37th on June 28, and the B Company NBC NCO on June 30.16 None contain a wind direction for March 4.

The second phase was the DAIG Phase 3 interview campaign of late 1996 through mid-1997. During this period the IG was already working the witness pool before the events that are commonly understood to have triggered the investigation. The Assistant S3 of the 307th Engineer Battalion received a call from the Army IG office on January 7, 1997, five weeks before the February 12 CBS broadcast. He refused to disclose the contents of that conversation to OSAGWI investigators the following day. The lead record notation is direct: he had received a call from the Army IG office and did not reveal what was discussed. The company commanders were already at Fort Leavenworth under institutional positioning. What the IG had not yet accomplished by February 12 was direct communications control over Captains Todd Hahn and Mike Huber, the two 37th Engineer Battalion company commanders who had been present at the March 4 demolition and who were among the officers at Fort Leavenworth.

Captain Mike Huber and Captain Todd Hahn were company commanders of the 37th Engineer Battalion and among the five commanders at Fort Leavenworth. They had not yet been reached by the IG when the broadcast aired. Captain Mike Huber, Captain Todd Hahn, and the author each gave separate on-camera interviews edited into the CBS Evening News broadcast of February 12, 1997, reported by David Martin. Huber appears at

timestamp 5:31:50, the author at 5:32:30, Hahn at 5:33:20, each in a distinct interview setting. The broadcast was possible because the IG had not yet reached them. The commanders were geographically controlled at Leavenworth but not yet communicatively controlled. The broadcast closed that gap. The IG moved to secure the remaining commanders after the broadcast exposed that two primary witnesses were still speaking freely.

The third phase was the May 1997 Leavenworth proceedings. OSAGWI conducted formal sworn interviews of the company commanders on May 6, followed by a press conference on May 7. The 5+1 session was controlled by the Army Inspector General, not by the Fort Leavenworth public affairs office. The author was denied entry by the IG officer running the event. He sat in the broadcast truck of a Kansas City news outlet and coordinated with the assembled news agencies on what questions to ask. When Captain Larson began describing rocket flyouts from the March 4 demolition, a reporter asked whether those were the 122mm chemical rockets. As Larson began to answer, the Inspector General officer terminated the press conference. The video has never been released. A selective release of any portion of the interview footage would invite the question of what else the tape contains. The entire record remains withheld because no portion of it can be released without exposing the rest.

The OSAGWI interim case narrative subsequently cited the 5+1 video as the source for three specific operational claims embedded in its official Khamisiyah timeline: that an advance party from the 37th arrived at Khamisiyah on March 2 based on a unit commander's personal recollection; that on March 10 the warehouses were blown up by Alpha Company of the 307th Engineer Battalion; and that on March 20 the berm area southwest of Khamisiyah was detonated by the 307th.22 These are not incidental citations. They represent a carefully constructed operational chronology that the press conference was organized to produce, with the commanders providing the sequential narrative of demolition activity that the official account required. Alpha Company was Larson's company. The 307th conducted the berm demolition. The only 307th company commander at the Leavenworth proceedings was Larson. The operational specifics attributed to the video for March 10 and March 20 activity could only have come from Larson. Yet in his

January 14, 1997 interview, four months before the press conference, Larson stated he had no knowledge of the pit's existence, despite attending all coordination meetings, and no knowledge of the bermed area containing more than 400 revetted bunkers identified by the 307th on March 12. The operational context makes this claim structurally impossible. The 307th Unit Operations Summary documents the sequence precisely.23 On March 10 the 307th completed the pit demolition. On March 11 at 0800 hours the battalion began withdrawal toward Jalibah Airfield. The unit was leaving. On March 12 the 307th discovered more than 400 additional revetted bunkers southwest of Khamisiyah at Tall al Lahm South, coordinates 30.2 degrees North, 46.1 degrees East. The retrograde stopped. Rigging operations on the newly discovered complex began March 15. Demolition was completed March 19. The company had been held in place for eight days by a discovery that extended the mission well beyond its planned conclusion. By that point the theater was unmistakably winding down: the ceasefire was three weeks old, infantry security had departed, and Iraqi prisoners of war were returning from Saudi Arabia by truck convoy past the unit's position on Highway 8. The 307th operated in an isolated position without defensive force, destroying additional ammunition at a facility whose full contents were unknown to the soldiers conducting the demolition. The discovery of 400 additional bunkers requiring demolition under those conditions is not an operational event that a company commander forgets. A commander who supervised the initial nine-day mission, was then stopped from leaving by an unexpected discovery, and completed eight additional days of demolition in the most anomalous and exposed circumstances of the deployment, does not fail to recall any of it. By May 1997, under IG management, the same commander provided precise operational detail for March 10 and March 20. The OSAGWI narrative cites the video for detailed operational content that the same officer did not possess in January.

VI. The Witness Progression in the Lead Report Record

The most direct evidence of Inspector General management of the witness record is the progression documented in two Lead Reports.

The Assistant S3 of the 307th Engineer Battalion (Lead Report 1221) was interviewed by OSAGWI on September 17, 1996. The record closed. On January 6, 1997, OSAGWI contacted him again. On January 7, he contacted the Army IG. On January 8, OSAGWI called again. He disclosed he had contacted the IG the previous day and refused to say what was discussed. The notation: "Did not reveal contents of conversation." Then he called OSAGWI back and said he had been cleared to talk. A witness does not contact the Inspector General to determine whether he is permitted to speak with investigators unless the IG has already established that it controls his communications. He waited for clearance. The IG granted it. Then he called back. This is not coordination between agencies. This is a witness in an active federal investigation receiving contact from a parallel government body, refusing to disclose that contact to the investigating team, and then waiting for authorization before resuming cooperation. That sequence, documented in the government's own lead record, is the clearest evidence in the series of what the IG's management of the witness pool actually was. It is not an investigation. It is witness management documented in the files of the investigation it was managing.

The A Company Commander of the 307th Engineer Battalion, Captain Chris Larson (Lead Report 1266), was first interviewed by phone on January 14, 1997.5 The document records his surprise at learning a second demolition site had existed: "He had attended all the coordination staff meetings held by the 37th, and did not remember hearing about the 'pit' or a large cache of rockets." He also states in the same interview that "he felt the wind was blowing to the NE at approx 2-3 knots" and that the cloud and debris from the explosion was blowing away from him and the MSR.

Two things are established by that statement. First, the Lead Info Requested field in Lead Report 1266 specifies NBC precautions, guidance from higher headquarters, details about EOD, and details about the pit. Wind direction was not among the questions OSAGWI asked. Larson volunteered it. A witness who volunteers specific meteorological detail that was not requested, in January 1997, after the PGIIT had been working the Khamisiyah witness pool since June 1996, is a witness whose answer was ready before the question was asked.

Second, the MSR clearance action Larson describes is not what he characterizes it as. The sequence documented in the lead record is that the M8A1 alarm activated, the NBC NCO conducted an M256 test that produced an inconclusive result, and Larson and the NBC NCO then got into the vehicle and drove to Highway 8 to conduct a second M256 test. He was not conducting a routine clearance check an hour after the demolition. He was responding to a chemical alarm with inconclusive agent readings by driving toward the highway to determine whether nerve agent was drifting onto it. That is the action of a commander who believed the plume was moving toward Highway 8. A commander who believed the cloud was drifting northeast at 2 to 3 knots away from his position and away from the road does not respond to an inconclusive M256 reading by immediately driving to the highway. He does that because the alarm and the readings told him the agent might be going where the highway is. The author was present at the canal when Larson departed. He asked directly whether the men should mask. He was told no. He immediately put two of his soldiers in the cab of his five-ton dump truck and had them mask regardless. They fell asleep. He was awakened by an NCO knocking on the door telling him to get out and unmask. That sequence, command order not to mask, independent judgment that the situation required it, soldiers masked and asleep in a truck cab while the company commander drove toward the highway to test for agent, is the operational record of what the alarm, the inconclusive readings, and the visible plume produced at the moment. His own emergency response is direct evidence of what the situation actually was. The stated wind direction and the documented response to the alarm cannot both be true. A parallel account compounds this further. The 307th Battalion liaison who remained at Khamisiyah throughout the operation (Lead Report 921) states that the battalion colonel may have flown over the pit area. A battalion commander who conducted aerial reconnaissance over the pit area does not claim ignorance of its existence. The battalion's own senior officer is documented as having overflown the site. The company commander attended all coordination meetings and did not hear about it.

Eleven months later, on December 9, 1997, following documented IG contact, Larson's account changed. He now stated wind direction and speed for March 4: 2 to 3 knots, northeast.

Witness	Initial Interview	Wind Direction	Follow-up	Wind Direction	Change
A Company Commander, 307th (Lead Report 1266)	January 14, 1997	NE at 2-3 knots; no knowledge of pit	December 9, 1997	NE wind, further specificity; full pit operational detail	Wind claim present from first interview; operational knowledge absent then present
Assistant S3, 307th (Lead Report 1221)	September 17, 1996	No wind content	January 6-8, 1997	IG contact January 7; called back January 8 cleared to talk by IG	IG authorization required before witness would speak

The 2 to 3 knot estimate is also unreliable on its own terms. Highway 8 runs south-southwest to north-northeast through the operational area, passing west of the Khamisiyah complex. Bunker 73 is east of Highway 8. Larson was driving along a road to the west of the detonation site. If the plume was moving northeast, it was moving away from Highway 8 entirely. Northeast transport carries agents away from a road positioned to the west. A commander does not personally drive down a road to check if it is safe to use when the plume is moving in the opposite direction. He does that when the plume is moving toward or across that road. The independent atmospheric reconstruction documented in Ford (2026a) establishes that actual wind conditions on March 4 would carry the plume northwest, toward the highway corridor and the A Company position.33 The stated wind direction and the documented MSR clearance action cannot both be true. Beyond the geometric problem, the physical claim is untenable on its own terms. Larson did not claim to observe wind. He claimed to observe the cloud and debris moving away from him and the MSR. At 2 to 3 knots a plume moves approximately 200 to 300 feet per minute. To visually

detect directional movement of a dissipating smoke and debris cloud at that drift speed from a fixed position requires sustained stationary observation over a minimum of ten to fifteen minutes. Larson was conducting an MSR clearance check, not a plume observation. He was driving a road to determine whether it was safe to use, one hour after the detonation, by which point any visible plume from a March 4 demolition would have substantially dissipated. The claim that he discerned a 2 to 3 knot directional drift from a vehicle on a clearance run is not a meteorological observation. It is a reconstruction, stated as a first-person observation of a physical phenomenon that could not have been verified by the method described. The statement is not an imprecise recollection. It is a combination of claims that cannot simultaneously be true.

The three-point progression is documented across three independent record sets: January 14, 1997, northeast wind claim present alongside stated ignorance of the pit's existence; May 7, 1997, full operational specificity about March 10 and March 20 attributed to the video by a commander who four months earlier denied knowledge of the pit; December 9, 1997, further wind direction specificity in a follow-up after documented IG contact. The central contradiction is not the wind claim's origin. It is the combination of a confident wind direction assertion from a commander who simultaneously claimed no knowledge of the event whose plume he was describing.

VII. The Wind Direction Evidence

The northeast wind claim for March 4 was not publicly asserted until July 24, 1997. The entire institutional apparatus described in this paper operated in the period between the event and the assertion, assembling the witness record that made the public assertion possible.

The meteorological basis for excluding northeast transport on March 4 is documented through six independent lines of atmospheric evidence in Ford (2026a).10 The Army IG Report does not cite the Air Force weather forecast, the NBC alarm activation location, or

any independent meteorological source in its treatment of Issue 7. It cites the CIA modeling as its authority for wind direction.

The M8A1 chemical alarm activated at approximately 1445 hours on March 4 in the 37th Engineer Battalion assembly area along the canal, northwest of the Bunker 73 detonation site. If wind was blowing northeast, chemical agents would have been carried away from that position. The alarm activated at the position placed in the direction of actual transport by every independent meteorological source. The Army IG Report resolves this geographic contradiction by attributing the alarm to a false positive based on prior false alarm experience, without addressing why a false positive would occur at the precise moment of the Bunker 73 detonation at the position that southeast winds would place in the plume path.

The CENTCOM NBC Desk Logs that would document Theater-level situational awareness of chemical agent movement on March 4 are missing. Their disappearance was the subject of a separate DoD Inspector General investigation published October 20, 1997.

The November 15, 1996 Fort Leavenworth DAIG Phase 3 interview transcript, a six-participant sworn interview session conducted during Phase 3 of the inquiry, is cited in seven endnotes of the OSAGWI interim case narrative. It has never been publicly released. At the July 24, 1997 Pentagon press briefing, Walpole stated:

> *"the wind pattern that had, for the day of Bunker 73, was moving in the northeast direction, and there were no troops in that direction"*

He also stated at the same briefing that the CIA had completed modeling of Bunker 73, that the data was superior to what was available for the pit, and that it was "easier to model." Those results were never released. The briefing ended when a reporter asked about chemical rockets in Bunker 73.

VIII. March 4 Versus March 10: The Deliberate Substitution

The March 4 Bunker 73 demolition and the March 10 pit demolition are separate events

involving different structures, different agent inventories, different meteorological conditions, and different unit configurations. The entire official exposure assessment was based exclusively on March 10.

The CBS Evening News broadcast of February 12, 1997 documents the investigative chain that produced the public acknowledgment of Khamisiyah. Every element of that chain is anchored to March 4 evidence: Captain Mike Huber's operational logs, the 37th Engineer Battalion videotape shot by Huber's driver, Brian Martin. The March 10 pit demolition does not appear in the broadcast record of the investigation. The decision to model March 10 rather than March 4 was made after the public acknowledgment, on the basis of a wind direction assertion whose evidentiary foundation this paper documents.

The exposure numbers make the institutional stakes explicit. The July 24, 1997 announcement identified 98,910 potentially exposed veterans based on the March 10 modeling alone. An honest atmospheric model of March 4 using the observational meteorological record documented in Ford (2026a) would have produced a plume moving toward the largest concentrations of U.S. forces in the theater.33 Between March 4 and March 10, the XVIII Airborne Corps was in active redeployment. Units present during the Bunker 73 demolition were moving south and southwest. By March 10 a substantially different force disposition existed around Khamisiyah. Geospatial reconstruction of unit positions from declassified operational records documents 34,528 personnel within 100 kilometers of the facility on March 4, with 47 units within the reconstructed atmospheric transport corridor under documented March 4 wind conditions. Those units carried unexposed status in the foundational data used to design epidemiological studies because no March 4 model was run.

The 2000 assessment reduced the March 10 source term by 55 percent and raised the exposure threshold by a factor of 3.3, contracting the March 10 footprint. Nineteen week-long G3/S3 conferences held between April 1997 and June 1998 at Fort Belvoir produced the revised unit location data used to justify both additions and removals. Not one document from those conference proceedings has ever been released to the public. The net result, 101,752 identified in 2000 versus 98,910 in 1997, presented a slight aggregate increase that masked specific unit removals. The numbers were managed, not measured.

The dual-exposure population compounds this further. Units positioned northwest of Khamisiyah on March 4, within the documented transport corridor, included formations that had not completed retrograde by March 10. Those units were in place for the Bunker 73 demolition and remained for the pit demolition. A unit present for both events received two separate nerve agent exposures six days apart, from two different directions, involving different agent release quantities. Their cumulative exposure was never assessed because March 4 was never modeled. They appear in the official record as possibly exposed once, if they remained on the exposure list at all.

The Research Advisory Committee on Gulf War Veterans' Illnesses identified in its 2008 report that exposure misclassification of this type biases epidemiological studies toward the null hypothesis.35 The committee noted that this misclassification was embedded in the foundational data used to design virtually all federal Gulf War illness research and could not be corrected post hoc.

IX. What the Lead Reports Establish That the DAIG Report Omits

The B Company NBC NCO of the 37th Engineer Battalion (Lead Report 825) states that an M-8 alarm activated during destruction operations, troops went to mask only, and no MOPP upgrade was ordered because the command structure in the 37th Engineer Battalion was downplaying chemical alarms. He identifies the battalion commander by name as having extended MOPP suit shelf-life beyond the authorized limit and as having directed troops not to don MOPP suits unless specifically ordered. He personally requested to speak with the battalion commander about NBC procedures and was refused. He states it is not a possibility but a probability that troops were exposed to chemical weapons. The Army IG Report's treatment of Issue 3 finds: *"Force protection measures taken during the ammunition demolition operation at Khamisiyah were generally appropriate."* The documented decisions do not appear in the findings.

The B Company Commander of the 37th (Lead Report 832) states that EOD inspected every bunker before charges were set and declared the area free of chemical weapons, and

that there was no information to the contrary. The CENTCOM message of February 23, 1991 had identified Khamisiyah as a suspected chemical weapons storage site. The XVIII Airborne Corps message of February 26, 1991 warned of possible chemicals on Objective Gold. The B Company Commander's statement that no information existed to the contrary is not a failure of memory. It is an accurate account of what his chain of command told him.

A witness interviewed in the same series (Lead Report 1223) states that the March 4 explosion was when he got exposed because demolition fragments fell in the designated safe area, raining down for up to 30 minutes, with the safe area approximately one mile from the demolition.16 The A Company NBC NCO of the 37th (Lead Report 909) documents that he performed an M256 test after the March 4 explosions that showed a trace for sarin, with the outside ring turning slightly pink. A second NBC NCO also obtained a positive reading. A subsequent test was negative. The Army IG Report's treatment of Issue 3 does not examine this sequence.

Lead Report 1053 page 2 is a written questionnaire directed at a witness containing ten specific questions about March 10 positioning: where the 37th Engineer Battalion element was when the demolition went off, how far away from the ammunition bunker site, and who may help clarify what happened in the pit area. No comparable questionnaire for March 4 positioning appears in any document produced in this investigation. The Lead Report 1053 questionnaire is the investigative apparatus constructing a March 10 record while leaving March 4 unaddressed. The SSG from the 60th EOD Detachment (Lead Report 1077) describes the pit demolition as carried out with a shaped charge intended to cut the rockets in two. UNSCOM's recovery of approximately 750 intact rockets from the pit area after the March 10 demolition confirms this method produced ejection rather than destruction across the majority of the inventory. The Army IG Report's source term is derived from the gap between the pre-demolition inventory and the UNSCOM recovery count. The physical mechanism documented in the SSG's account is inconsistent with the agent release assumptions embedded in the modeling methodology. The IG Report does not examine this inconsistency.

X. The Command Decision at Tallil

On March 3, 1991, the command decision to proceed with the Khamisiyah demolition was communicated at Tallil Air Base. The guidance given was that there were boats at port, that the competition was between the 82nd Airborne Division and the 24th Infantry Division to reach them first, and that there was no chemical material in theater. The decision was communicated under an explicit assertion that no chemical weapons were present, despite the fact that the XVIII Airborne Corps message of February 26, 1991 warning of possible chemicals on Objective Gold had already been transmitted, and the CENTCOM guidance of February 24, 1991 governing disposition of captured chemical munitions had already been issued.

The secret ARCENT NBC staff memorandum dated March 23, 1991, now declassified, states:

> *ARCENT has positive confirmation (by urinalysis) of cml agent blister casualty in VII corps. We are not to bring this up to the press. If press asks, XVIII Abn Corps has had no cml casualties.*

The instruction not to discuss confirmed chemical casualties was issued before the troops had left the theater. The narrative that became "no chemicals, no exposure, no illness" was operational policy from the first weeks after the ceasefire.

During this same operational period, seven soldiers of the 27th Engineer Battalion were killed in an accidental explosion while preparing U.S. unexploded munitions at As Salman Airfield, 170 kilometers southwest of Khamisiyah. The 20th Engineer Brigade was simultaneously managing the Khamisiyah demolitions and absorbing the loss of seven of its engineers. These soldiers are noted here. They have not been part of any official account of the Khamisiyah period.

XI. The Structure of a Predetermined Conclusion

The CIA's Pit modeling report was published September 4, 1997. The DAIG Report was

published October 10, 1997. The CIA had fixed the official technical narrative thirty-five days before the Army Inspector General's findings went public. The DAIG Report was not evaluating the modeling. It arrived after the CIA had already published the framework within which its findings would be interpreted. It was ratifying conclusions the modeling had already made public.

The witness interview campaign had already begun in June 1996, under the PGIIT, before the DAIG directive and before OSAGWI. The northeast transport narrative was not yet a public assertion. It required the witness corroboration that the IG and OSAGWI were building. The wind direction testimonies cited in official narratives as corroborating the northeast conclusion were produced during that construction period, assembled specifically so the claim could be made. A conclusion that requires the construction of its own evidentiary support before it can be stated publicly is not a finding. It is a frame into which evidence is subsequently fitted.

The Lead Report record documents the fitting process. The wind direction claim appears in the initial interview alongside a statement of ignorance about the pit itself. Specificity increases over time. Specificity increases over time. Officers whose initial accounts contain no wind direction references produce detailed azimuth and speed estimates in subsequent interviews conducted after documented IG contact. The November 15, 1996 Fort Leavenworth DAIG Phase 3 interview transcript, cited in seven endnotes of the OSAGWI interim case narrative, has never been publicly released. A second transcript has also never been released: the formal proceedings of May 6, 1997, titled "Interviews Concerning Activities at Khamisiyah, Iraq in March 1991," conducted by the Office of the Special Assistant to the Deputy Secretary of Defense for Gulf War Illnesses at Fort Leavenworth, is cited in the OSAGWI final case narrative at pages 153 through 154 and remains unavailable for public examination.7a The CENTCOM NBC Desk Logs that would provide the contemporaneous Theater-level record of chemical agent movement on March 4 are missing and the subject of a separate federal investigation.

This is not the profile of an investigation that discovered evidence and followed it to a conclusion. It is the profile of an investigation that managed a conclusion and arranged evidence around it. The distinction has consequences for approximately 430 soldiers who

were at Khamisiyah on March 4, 1991, for the additional troops whose positions placed them in the path of the March 4 plume under every meteorological reconstruction that relies on observed data, and for the epidemiological record that has spent three decades trying to establish a causal link between chemical exposure and Gulf War illness in a study population assembled on the basis of the March 10 exposure list.

Veterans present only on March 4, 1991, who were not within the March 10 plume footprint were subsequently reclassified as unexposed through the 1997 and 2000 modeling assessments, removed from the exposure list, and assigned to the unexposed cohorts in epidemiological studies whose findings have shaped the medical and scientific understanding of Gulf War illness for three decades.

Every institutional decision documented in this paper occurred within a single administration. The PGIIT was created by a Clinton appointee. The CIA modeling was produced under a Clinton-appointed Director of Central Intelligence. The Joint Chiefs briefed the NSC on Khamisiyah in November 1991 and no action was taken. The March 23, 1991 ARCENT NBC memorandum instructing commands not to discuss confirmed chemical casualties was issued six weeks after the ceasefire under a chain of command that ran to the Commander in Chief. The DAIG inquiry was directed by the Secretary of the Army serving under a Clinton Defense Department. The S3/G3 conferences were organized by OSAGWI under a Clinton-appointed Special Assistant. The Rostker-Walpole correspondence closing the Bunker 73 modeling question was written in December 1999. John Deutch was pardoned by President Clinton on January 19, 2001, his last day in office, two days before the Department of Justice could file the case. The coordinating authority above every institutional node documented in this paper resided in the Clinton White House. The reader is left to draw the conclusion the evidence requires.

Notes

1. Department of the Army Inspector General, *Inquiry into Demolition of Iraq Ammunition, September 1996-October 1997* (Washington, DC: Department of the

Army, October 10, 1997), Executive Summary. Hereinafter DAIG Report. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/army_ig/ and https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/citations/ADA343893.

2. DAIG Report, Chapter I, Phase 3.
3. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 1221, Interview of 307th Engineer Battalion Assistant S3, September 17, 1996; follow-up contacts January 6 and 8, 1997. CMAT Control 2000335-0000026. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_ii/khamisiyah_ii_refs/n15en113/1221ld1.htm.
4. Ibid.
5. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 1266, Interview of commander, Company A, 307th Engineer Battalion, January 14, 1997 and December 9, 1997. CMAT Control 2000335-0000033. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_ii/khamisiyah_ii_refs/n15en106/1266ld1.htm.
6. Ibid.
7. Transcript, Fort Leavenworth DAIG Phase 3 Interview Session, November 15, 1996. Cited in Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point" (interim case narrative, April 14, 1997), endnotes 80, 91, 92, 94, 105, 108, and 110. Transcript not publicly released. [Note: This November 1996 session is a six-participant DAIG sworn interview conducted during Phase 3 of the inquiry and is entirely distinct from the May 1997 Leavenworth 5+1 OSAGWI proceedings.]

7a. Transcript of Proceedings, "Interviews Concerning Activities at Khamisiyah, Iraq in March 1991," Office of the Special Assistant to the Deputy Secretary of Defense for Gulf War Illnesses, Fort Leavenworth, Kansas, May 6, 1997, pp. 153-154. Cited in Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point, Final Report," April 16, 2002. Not publicly released.

8. CBS Evening News, broadcast February 12, 1997, reporter David Martin, anchor Dan Rather. Vanderbilt Television News Archive broadcast number 374012. Participants:

Captain Todd Hahn, Captain Mike Huber, Jeffrey Ford, Larry Fox, Charles Duelfer.

9. Department of Defense and Central Intelligence Agency, Press Briefing Transcript, July 24, 1997. Statement of Robert Walpole, CIA Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses.

9a. Central Intelligence Agency, "CIA Report on Intelligence Related to Gulf War Illnesses," August 2, 1996. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/cia_report/102496_war.html.

9b. Robert D. Walpole, "Statement of Robert D. Walpole, Special Assistant to the ADCI for Persian Gulf War Illnesses Issues, Before the Presidential Advisory Committee on Gulf War Veterans' Illnesses," March 18, 1997. Available at https://www.cia.gov/cia/publications/gulfwar/walpole2/creation.htm. This statement predates the July 24, 1997 public assertion of northeast transport and warrants examination for intermediate wind direction language.

9c. Central Intelligence Agency Office of Inspector General, Special Assessment, "The Central Intelligence Agency's Handling of Information Related to the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Depot," February 5, 1998. Classified.

10. DAIG Report, Chapter III, Issue 7.
11. U.S. Air Force Air Weather Service, Weather Forecast for Southern Iraq, 4 March 1991. Declassified. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/weather/.
12. DAIG Report, Chapter III, Issues 1 and 3.
13. Department of Defense and Central Intelligence Agency, Press Briefing Transcript, July 24, 1997. Statement of Robert Walpole.
14. Bernard Rostker to Robert Walpole, December 13, 1999. Declassified correspondence. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil.
15. CBS Evening News, February 12, 1997. Statement of Larry Fox, CIA analyst.
16. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 825, Interview of B Company NBC NCO, 37th Engineer Battalion, June 30, 1996. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_ii/khamisiyah_ii_refs/n15en096/825ld1.htm.

17. DAIG Report, Chapter III, Issue 3.
18. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 832, Interview of B Company Commander, 37th Engineer Battalion, June 28, 1996. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_ii/khamisiyah_ii_refs/n15en097/832ld1.htm.
19. Commander, U.S. Army Central Command, Message, Subject: Captured or Abandoned Chem/Bio Munitions, 232020Z FEB 91; XVIII Airborne Corps, Message, Subject: Suspected Chemical Agent Contamination, 031015Z FEB 91. Both available at https://gulflink.health.mil.

16a. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 1223, available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_iii/khamisiyah_iii_refs/n70en090/1223ld1.htm. Page 3 documents fragment fall into the safe area during the March 4 demolition.

20. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 909, Interview of A Company NBC NCO, 37th Engineer Battalion, September 12, 1996. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil. [Pre-publication: verify specific URL.]
21. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 1077, Interview of SSG, 60th EOD Detachment, October 23, 1996. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_ii/khamisiyah_ii_refs/n15en093/1077ld1.htm.
22. DAIG Report, Chapter IV.
23. 307th Engineer Battalion, Unit Operations Summary: Operation Desert Shield/Desert Storm (Fort Bragg, NC: U.S. Army, 1991). Available at https://www.gulflink.osd.mil/khamisiyah/kham_ref/n01en050/307sum1.htm. The summary documents the battalion's 216-hour mission destroying 100 bunkers and 43 warehouses, the March 11 withdrawal initiation, the March 12 discovery of the Tall al Lahm South complex, the March 15 commencement of rigging operations, and the March 19 completion of demolition.

24. Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, GulfLINK News Article, S3/G3 Conference Process [specific title and URL req. from original article]. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil. [Pre-publication: verify specific article title and URL from preserved GulfLINK document collection.]
25. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 6664, Interview of XVIII Airborne Corps G3 Plans officer, September 4, 1997. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil.
26. Department of the Army Inspector General, Lead Report ID 18591, Interview of CENTCOM J5 staff officer, August 17, 1998. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil.
27. Office of the Inspector General, Department of Defense, *Report of Investigation Concerning the Missing U.S. Central Command Nuclear, Biological and Chemical Desk Logs* (Washington, DC: DoD IG, October 20, 1997). Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/dodig/.
28. Bernard Rostker to Robert Walpole, December 13, 1999.
29. Institute for Defense Analyses, Report of the Panel on Modeling the Chemical Warfare Agent Release at the Khamisiyah Pit, July 9, 1997. General Larry D. Welch (USAF, Ret.), Chair. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil and https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/citations/ADA341776. The endnote numbers 80, 91, 92, 94, 105, 108, and 110 cited in Note 7 are from the OSAGWI interim case narrative "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point," April 14, 1997, not the follow-up report of December 5, 2000 or the final report of April 25, 2002.
30. Robert D. Baer, "The Most Dangerous Contractor," Vanity Fair, September 2007, for SAIC employee security clearance figures and revenue context. Revenue figure reflects SAIC's peak period contemporaneous with Khamisiyah modeling contracts; verify exact revenue year against primary SAIC annual report if precision is required. For SAIC modeling work see also: Science Applications International Corporation, Initial Khamisiyah Exposure Modeling (SAIC, 1997), available at https://apps.dtic.mil/sti/citations/ADA337499.

31. Army ARCENT NBC Staff Memorandum (Secret, subsequently declassified), March 23, 1991. Available at https://gulflink.health.mil.
32. Jeffrey S. Ford, "Geospatial Reconstruction of U.S. Military Unit Positions During Demolition Operations at Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point, Iraq, March 1991: A Multi-Source Methodology for Historical Military Record Integration," preprint, ResearchGate, March 2026, DOI: 10.13140/RG.2.2.11953.13922. Available at https://www.researchgate.net/publication/403184302.
33. Research Advisory Committee on Gulf War Veterans' Illnesses, Gulf War Illness and the Health of Gulf War Veterans: Scientific Findings and Recommendations (Washington, DC: U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs, 2008), available at https://www.va.gov/RAC-GWVI/docs/Committee_Documents/GWIandHealthofGWVeterans_RAC-GWVIReport_2008.pdf.
34. Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point," April 14, 1997 (interim case narrative). Available at https://gulflink.health.mil/retired/khamisiyah_041497/kham7.html and https://health.mil/Military-Health-Topics/Environmental-Exposures-Hub/Environmental-Exposures-Topics/GulfLINK/Gulf-War-Library/Case-Narratives/US-Demolition-Operations-at-the-KASP. Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point, Follow-up Report," December 5, 2000. Available at https://health.mil/Military-Health-Topics/Environmental-Exposures-Hub/Environmental-Exposures-Topics/GulfLINK/Gulf-War-Library/Case-Narratives/US-Demolition-Operation-at-the-KASP-Follow-Up. Office of the Special Assistant for Gulf War Illnesses, "U.S. Demolition Operations at the Khamisiyah Ammunition Storage Point, Final Report," April 16, 2002. Available at https://health.mil/Military-Health-Topics/Environmental-Exposures-Hub/Environmental-Exposures-Topics/GulfLINK/Gulf-War-Library/Case-

Narratives/Khamisiyah-Ammunition-Storage-Point-Final-Report and https://gulflink.health.mil/khamisiyah_iii/index.htm.

Privacy Notice: This paper names only individuals whose identities appear in unredacted form in publicly released GulfLINK documents, in public broadcast records including the February 12, 1997 CBS Evening News broadcast, or in official public records including congressional testimony, government press releases, and published government reports. Individuals identified only in declassified documents where their names appear in redacted form are not named in this paper, regardless of whether their identities may be determinable through other means. This standard is applied without exception. The February 12, 1997 CBS Evening News broadcast (Vanderbilt Television News Archive broadcast number 374012, reporter David Martin, anchor Dan Rather) was purchased by the author from the Vanderbilt Television News Archive and used for background analysis. On-camera participants are identified by name consistent with their voluntary public appearance in that broadcast.